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CHAPTER 1. THEORETICAL BACKGROUND

The first chapter will serve two purposes: The first is to equip you with the understanding you will need of the main key terms you are going to be working with. However, you are not just given definitions. The idea is to offer you a way of developing your own understanding of key concepts and to be able to evaluate the meanings others attach to the terms you will meet. Secondly, Section 1 discusses the background to the subject so that you can appreciate why and how it has developed. The different influences on its development are important. At first it may be difficult to see how this is relevant to your wanting to understand business and management today, but the developments of today emerge from this background and are often influenced by the major events and theories of the past.

This study adopts a gender perspective to analyze funding decisions made by an investment fund that invests equity stakes in new ventures. Prior research has indicated that there is gender skewness in risk capital investments resulting from a combination of demand- and supply-side issues. We apply signaling theory to examine the interface between demand and supply to understand gender biases related to risk capital investments. In-depth analyses of decision documents from four investment cases show that gender plays a role in the signals that are communicated in the prefunding entrepreneur investor relationship.

1. Background

Let's think about the concept of 'organisation'. Many definitions are possible, but most of these include the characteristics of people, goals and structures. People are social beings and, by and large, tend to cooperate in interdependent relationships to achieve common aims. Originally people formed simple family and tribal structures. Today we have evolved into a complex society characterised by large, formal and increasingly global structures. For our purposes, then, we can define an organisation as: a social entity that provides the necessary structures to achieve specific aims.

For our purposes in this subject guide, we will understand the term business to mean: a commercial enterprise or establishment that trades in goods or services.

We can define the business organisation as: an entity that is both commercial and social, which provides the necessary structures to achieve the central objective of trades in goods or services.